

Development within Reserve Areas shall take place either in accordance with an approved planned community master plan (up to three dwelling units per acre), or in accordance with the standards applicable to Rural Areas.

Possible Techniques

- 1) Zone County Reserve Area land from one to twenty acres per dwelling unit based on environmental characteristics.
- 2) When annexing Reserve Areas without a planned community master plan, establish a low intensity holding zone (e.g. 5 acres/d.u.).
- 3) Annex and establish City zoning to allow more intensive development only upon acceptance of a planned community master plan; implement land use, design requirements, and other stipulations.
- 4) Include performance clauses in the City Subdivision Ordinance and the site development plan development regulations of the Zoning Code which invalidates plans if construction has not begun within a specified period of time.

Policy d

A planned community master plan approved in accordance with this section and more specific development criteria shall serve to implement the Comprehensive Plan. A planned community master plan shall not be approved if it fails to demonstrate its own sense of place, self-sufficiency, environmental sensitivity, separation from the contiguous Albuquerque urban area by permanent open space and the provision of infrastructure which is not a net expense to the local government(s).

3. RURAL AREA

The **Goal** is to maintain the separate identity of Rural Areas as alternatives to urbanization by guiding development compatible with their open character, natural resources, and traditional settlement patterns.

Policy a

Rural Areas as shown by a **Plan** map shall generally retain their rural character with development consisting primarily of ranches, farms and single-family homes on large lots; higher density development may occur at appropriate locations - within rural villages or planned communities. Overall gross densities shall not exceed one dwelling unit per acre.

- Rural Area density patterns shall be more specifically defined through lower rank plans.
- Higher density development must provide local government with property rights ensuring appropriate overall-area gross density.
- Each higher density area is to be controlled by site development plan and is to be located well away from other such higher density areas.
- Small “rural villages” should contain compact housing areas - usually no more than 100 dwellings - with very few stores to serve the village.
- Planned communities will follow the Reserve Area policies concerning such communities, except:

Lower gross density requirements;

The automatic requirement for unified urban government; and

In the East Mountain area, the average net density of permanent residential areas will be urban, the exact density to be determined by lower ranking plans, not this **Plan**.

- New rural villages and planned communities will be approved only if all public infrastructure needed primarily to serve the proposed areas is provided at the cost of the developers.

Possible Techniques

- 1) Map agricultural zone districts on land qualifying for greenbelt tax status.
- 2) Prepare and adopt area plans specifying appropriate density patterns; implement through the Zoning and Subdivision Ordinances.

- 3) Use county zones which limit development densities to between 1 to 20 acres per dwelling unit based on land carrying capacity.
- 4) Provide incentives for development of cluster housing sensitive to natural constraints and adjacent development.
- 5) Consider extensions of City public services and facilities to Rural Areas only where:

Public health and safety are threatened and there is no safe alternative; or

A planned community is approved and being developed, for which extension of certain services and facilities is economically feasible and environmentally sound; or

The extension is part of an adopted policy of metropolitan area service.
- 6) Monitor development through a comprehensive data base.
- 7) Determine, through the rank two planning process, where Rural Area boundaries may be altered to reflect existing and planned conditions.
- 8) Include performance clauses in the Subdivision and the Zoning Ordinances which invalidates plans if construction has not begun within a specified period of time.

Policy b

Development in Rural Areas shall be compatible with natural resource capacities, including water availability and soil capacity, community and regional goals, and shall include trail corridors where appropriate.

Possible Techniques

- 1) Develop design criteria for use in development review to minimize adverse environmental effects of development (e.g. require terracing and roads parallel to contours on steep slopes).
- 2) Develop and adopt area and sector plans specifying guidelines based on resource characteristics and unique community concerns and opportunities; implement through Zoning and Subdivision Ordinances.
- 3) Ensure compatible development and density through review and possible revision of the county Zoning and Subdivision ordinances.
- 4) Encourage and support development of community water and waste systems consistent with protecting the resource base and water quality.
- 5) Amend the Subdivision Ordinances to require dedication of designated trail corridors.